

Eclipse ORC WG Steering Committee F2F

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We wanted to use the opportunity to meet F2F between the steering group members attending OCX. The idea was to discuss [2026 ORC Program](#) and discuss what works well and what are the challenges the members observe. We hope this facilitates steering committee discussion to conclude on 2026 ORC Program review.

For reference, latest SC call presentation (Q1 2026 report):
[2026-04-16-orcwg-sc-presentation.pdf](#) and [Notes](#).

1. Discussion on the value of Strategic Membership
 - The membership base has grown, but the number of strategic members is not. This is seen as an issue, especially if ORC WG should become self-sustainable in 2027, or at least less dependent on Eclipse funding. Not reaching the level of self-sustainability (what is this, 100% or >50% of ORC funding from membership fees, or something else?) could jeopardize the ability of ORC to deliver according to membership's hopes and plans. We need discussion with Eclipse staff regarding the expectations and timeline for ORC self-sustainability.
 - The value of strategic membership is questioned. We see many intangible benefits – awareness, showing thought leadership, etc. There's a sentiment we do not see enough tangible benefits, and this makes it a hard sell with the current strategic members to internally justify continuation on that membership level. We're worried about the potential domino effect should companies like Mercedes decide to quit as strategic member. Also, without proper tangible benefits it is harder to secure new strategic members.
 - An example of a strategic member benefits an idea of a training program was brought up, training with an expanded experience to the strategic member companies (in-person, AMA, etc.) besides just publicly available.
 - Another benefit could be strategic members getting x amount of tickets for free to the events (C&C, OCX) as part of membership.
 - Expanding the scope of ORC WG beyond the CRA would show continued value of the WG. Being agile and tap on next things coming. NB, this is being addressed with establishing AI Policy and Compliance SIG. We need to closely follow other emerging topics (e.g. Sovereignty, DORA/NIS2 harmonization, Digital Omnibus, CAIDA, AI Standards, etc.) to make sure the scope of the ORC is current and compelling for members and community to keep supporting it.
2. Planning is challenging without visibility to resources
 - ORC WG is quite dependent on Eclipse staff engagement and contribution. This is especially true in context of EC Expert Group and engagement with ESOs. However, visibility to the availability of and duration of the engagement of the staff members is not very clear to the members. Hence e.g. a question "Where's Marta and Mika?", as both had been visible and active in CRA standardisation but don't seem to be

anymore. On the same token, clarification of the role of staff members is needed to make sure we understand covering policy things doesn't affect other priority topics. Overall, better visibility to allocation of staff resources would be good.

3. Comments on ORC Program Plan 2026 review

- Standardisation work: Strong sentiment that standardisation work shall be prioritised. Eclipse should establish good level of engagement with CEN/CLC to make sure they have a strong voice there. Overall, Eclipse should establish itself as an active player in standardisation as FOSS industry will be more and more regulated (specifically, in the AI era), whereby this engagement will need to happen somewhere anyway. Emphasising standardisation could lead to prioritization discussion - drop some activities if we feel there is no capacity to carry out what we have started or planned.
- Institutional engagement: Contributing to consultations and future regulations is valuable and very well perceived by the Commission. ORC is visible to the Commission and ENISA already (though we still don't have an early access to ENISA SRP which would be a good example of tangible benefits for strategic members), but not to national level agencies. Engaging with those bodies long-term is valuable. Can we expect Eclipse is a trusted proxy for members to get connected with MSAs, CSIRTs etc. We see no traction yet. Who is doing it, what is the plan? Policy Engagement Forum - give us more details, maybe we can postpone? Scoping question is here as well, can we keep up with all the initiatives in the program?
- Attestation and Due Diligence: We felt due diligence is not doing that great (not really green) yet, we are not at tipping point to see proper progress (white page syndrome still). Attestations and due diligence are market trend setters, to allow consultants and others to use it, but IT-industry is not clear yet how to apply or use it.
- ORC Community Representation (slide 9): What's the pipeline and how can members help/advocate to engage with new members? If prioritization is needed, emphasis shall be on growing membership base rather than putting effort in cooperating with other foundations. Related to prioritization and resourcing, working with verticals and industries - how much time/effort does it take?
- Role Matrix (slide 10): How to make sure we (members) contribute actual engineering work? We're suggesting doing more workshops on priority areas. It will also help to attract more community members to participate, once they see clear benefits in the planned outcomes (communicate the user story: "as a manufacturer who employs FOSS maintainers I'd like to reduce work duplications and make sure due diligence is simplified...") and "lead by example".
- Outside of program plan: Should we start preparing for CRA-2, i.e. an update of the CRA, for which there are rumors? Should we expand our radar screen to cover policy actions outside of EU, in USA, China, India, etc. so that we emerge into true international collaboration with extended value for participants across the globe ?
- Last comment, to end with positive note: FAQ is visible and potentially beneficial reference to our members/customers. Everyone agrees it's awesome. We just need to make sure we have a solid promotion plan for it (more references from the EU Commission, campaign, workshops/webinars how to use it, etc.).